

Mirror – Chiral Toolkit

User Manual

Mingrui Zuo & Lifeng Ding
Xi'an Jiaotong-Liverpool University

Version 0.6 – June 2026

Contents

1	Overview	2
1.1	Technology Stack	2
2	Launching the Application	2
3	Tab 1: PDB Enantiomer (Mirror Generator)	2
3.1	Workflow	2
3.2	Notes	2
4	Tab 2: CPA Alignment	2
4.1	Workflow	3
5	Tab 3: CIF Toolkits	3
5.1	Structure Visualization	3
5.2	Symmetry Analysis	3
5.3	Element-based Channel Map	3
5.4	Grid-based Pore Detection & VDW Heatmap	3
5.5	Turbo Mode	4
6	Tab 4: Accessible Orientations	4
6.1	Workflow	4
6.2	Three-Region Partition	4
6.3	Pore Explorer	4
7	Tab 5: Database Browser	4
8	Tab 6: Information	4
9	Batch Scripts	5
10	Output Data	5

1 Overview

Mirror (Chiral Toolkit) is a molecular-structure analysis platform built with Streamlit. It provides six functional tabs for the analysis of porous crystalline frameworks (CIF) and guest molecules (PDB).

1.1 Technology Stack

Component	Technology
Frontend	Streamlit (Python 3.12)
3D Visualisation	py3Dmol / stmol / NGL Viewer
Crystallography	pymatgen (SpacegroupAnalyzer, Lattice)
Numerical	NumPy, SciPy (ndimage, signal)
Machine Learning	scikit-learn
Plotting	Matplotlib (Agg backend)
File parsing	Custom CIF / PDB / DEF parsers

2 Launching the Application

Run from the project root:

```
streamlit run app.py
```

Or double-click `run.bat` on Windows. The app opens at <http://localhost:8501>.

3 Tab 1: PDB Enantiomer (Mirror Generator)

Generates mirror images of molecules from PDB or RASPA DEF files.

3.1 Workflow

1. Upload a `.pdb` or `.def` file.
2. View molecular analysis: formula, atom count, mass, bounding box, VDW radii, geometric and mass-weighted centroids.
3. Select a mirror plane: **YZ (invert x)**, **XZ (invert y)**, or **XY (invert z)**.
4. The mirrored structure is displayed alongside the original.
5. Download the mirrored PDB or mirrored DEF.

3.2 Notes

- Reflection is performed about the geometric centroid.
- For DEF files, only the atom-position block is modified; force-field parameters are preserved.

4 Tab 2: CPA Alignment

Canonical Principal Axes (CPA) alignment rotates a molecule so that its principal axes of inertia align with the Cartesian axes.

4.1 Workflow

1. Upload a `.pdb` file.
2. Toggle hydrogen visibility and render style (stick, sphere/CPK, line).
3. Select method: **mass-weighted** (inertia tensor) or **geometric** (covariance matrix).
4. Click **Standardize Structure**.
5. Four views are shown: Original, Mirrored (YZ reflection), CPA-aligned, and MCPA-aligned.
6. Each view displays principal moments (I_1, I_2, I_3) and the ratio I_1/I_3 . Degeneracy or near-spherical shape is flagged.
7. Download the CPA or MCPA PDB.

For the mathematical theory, see the separate *Mathematics and Algorithms* document.

The central analysis tab for porous crystals.

4.2 Structure Visualization

- Upload a `.cif` file.
- Adjust supercell dimensions (n_a, n_b, n_c).
- Toggle cell box and background colour.
- Rendered via NGL Viewer.

4.3 Symmetry Analysis

Runs `pymatgen.SpacegroupAnalyzer` across multiple tolerances (`symprec` = 0.01, 0.05, 0.1, 0.2). Reports:

- Best space-group symbol and number.
- Confidence score (fraction of tolerances in agreement).
- Sohncke and enantiomorphic flags.
- Full scan table.

4.4 Element-based Channel Map

Detects 1D channels via 2D Voronoi tessellation in the ab -plane.

4.5 Grid-based Pore Detection & VDW Heatmap

A detailed method producing:

- Distance-field map with pore centre and radius.
- Cylindrical projection of wall atoms (element-coloured).
- Smooth Gaussian VDW heatmap on the θ - z plane.
- FFT-based pore-shape classification: L2, L3, L4, or L6.

4.6 Turbo Mode

Ultra-fast alternative using Voronoi tessellation + KDTree. Suitable for real-time interactive use.

5 Tab 4: Accessible Orientations

Places a guest molecule inside a host channel and scans all orientations.

5.1 Workflow

1. Upload host CIF and guest PDB.
2. Preview four guest orientations: Original, Mirrored, CPA-guest, MCPA-guest.
3. Toggle CPA alignment and select collision method (**voxel** or **vdw**).
4. Extract the centralised channel (periodic replication along c).
5. View fit analysis (pore diameter vs. guest box diagonal).
6. Run channel accessibility (Mollweide map, θ - ϕ heatmap).
7. Configure scan (θ and ϕ steps, clash scale, mirror plane) and click **Scan Orientations**.

5.2 Three-Region Partition

Rolls the guest envelope sphere through the pore cross-section:

- **Green**: envelope fits — all orientations OK.
- **Amber**: only centroid fits — limited orientations.
- **Red**: centroid does not fit.

5.3 Pore Explorer

Interactively positions a crosshair and computes L/D orientation spheres. Displays 3D sphere, clearance heatmap, and L vs. D comparison.

6 Tab 5: Database Browser

Browse the CoRE-COF 1242 database.

- Search by name or number.
- Table with PLD, LCD, Density, Topology.
- Select a COF to view metadata.
- **Import & Run**: loads the CIF, runs symmetry analysis, and executes grid-based pore detection with full visual output.

7 Tab 6: Information

Project goals, planned features, and contact details.

8 Batch Scripts

Scripts in `modules/scripts/`:

Script	Purpose
<code>benchmark_database.py</code>	Full-database pore detection
<code>batch_pore_morphology.py</code>	Batch morphology computation
<code>batch_fitness.py</code>	Host-guest fitness screening
<code>spinol_ml_analysis.py</code>	ML regression on spinol selectivity
<code>plot_morphology_scatter.py</code>	CI-coloured scatter plots
<code>plot_topology_pie.py</code>	Layer-cake topology/SG/sgType
<code>plot_sgtype_ddg.py</code>	sgType vs $\Delta\Delta G$
<code>scaling_benchmark.py</code>	Timing-scaling benchmarks

9 Output Data

Batch results are in `modules/database/benchmark/`:

- `pore_morphology.xlsx`: 1099 COFs $\times$ 24 columns (pore radius, CI, CF, curvature, Fourier powers, helicity, etc.)
- `benchmark.xlsx`: 1242 COFs with symmetry and dimensions.
- PNG figures (topology cake plots, SG/sgType distributions, scatter plots, ML diagnostics).